FREE PLAYBOOK · 2026

# The 12 Buying Signals that tell you a B2B company is about to buy

Every signal, where to spot it, and the exact first message to send.

01 Asks a question about the problem you solve

02 Likes three posts on the topic in one week

03 Comments on a competitor's post

04 Follows your profile

05 Views your profile twice

06 Changes job title

07 Company starts hiring for the role you replace

08 Company raises a round

09 Posts a "we're looking for" request

10 Complains about a tool in your category

11 Reddit thread asking for recommendations

12 X post tagging a competitor

BEFORE YOU START

# How to use this list

**The best first message goes to someone who already gave you a reason to send it. These 12 signals are those reasons, and each one needs its own opener.**

A cold list tells you who *could* buy. A signal tells you who is moving *now*: they asked, they reacted, they changed something. Reply to the signal, not to the job title.

Each signal has four parts: what it means, where you see it, the first message to send, and what not to say. Swap the [brackets] for real details. If you can't fill a bracket honestly, don't send the message.

## Three rules for every first message

1. **Name the signal.**
   Say what you saw (their question, their post, their new role) in the first line. That is your permission to write.

2. **Give before you ask.**
   An answer, an example or a useful link first. No calendar link in message one.

3. **Under 60 words, one question.**
   Short enough to read on a phone, easy to answer with one line.

## The three groups

01–04
**They're engaging with the problem**

05–08
**Something changed on their side**

09–12
**They're asking out loud**

01

THEY'RE ENGAGING WITH THE PROBLEM

## Asks a question about the problem you solve

Very high

Reply: Same day

**WHAT IT MEANS**

They're stuck right now and looking for a way out. This is the warmest signal on the list.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

A LinkedIn post or comment such as "how do you handle...", "what's the best way to...".

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name], saw your question about [problem]. What's worked for teams like yours: [one concrete answer in a sentence]. Happy to share the [checklist / example] we use if useful. Is it [option A] or [option B] that's slowing you down?

**DON'T** pitch in the first line, or answer in a comment and then DM the same thing.

02

THEY'RE ENGAGING WITH THE PROBLEM

## Likes three posts on the topic in one week

Medium

Reply: This week

**WHAT IT MEANS**

The topic is on their mind this week, even if they haven't said so.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

The reactions on posts about your topic, yours or anyone's.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name], noticed you've been following the conversation about [topic] this week. We just put together [resource] on exactly that. Want me to send it over?

**DON'T** say "I saw you liked 3 posts". Name the topic, not the tracking.

03

THEY'RE ENGAGING WITH THE PROBLEM

## Comments on a competitor's post

Medium

Reply: This week

**WHAT IT MEANS**

They're comparing options, and a competitor got there first.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Comments under posts from [competitor] or its founders.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name], saw your comment on [competitor]'s post about [topic]. Fair point on [their point]. We see the same thing from the other side: [one-line difference]. Are you looking at tools for this, or just following along?

**DON'T** criticise the competitor. Add a second opinion, not an attack.

04

THEY'RE ENGAGING WITH THE PROBLEM

## Follows your profile

Low

Reply: Anytime

**WHAT IT MEANS**

Something you posted landed. They chose to hear more from you.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Your followers list and notifications.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Thanks for the follow, [name]. Curious what brought you here: the posts on [topic], or something you're working on at [company]?

**DON'T** send a pitch deck to someone who only pressed Follow.

05

SOMETHING CHANGED ON THEIR SIDE

## Views your profile twice

Low

Reply: This week

**WHAT IT MEANS**

They're checking you out, often after seeing a post or hearing your name. Twice means it wasn't an accident.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

"Who viewed your profile".

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name], looks like our paths crossed on here. I help [type of company] with [outcome]. If [problem] is on your list at [company], happy to share how others are handling it. If not, no worries.

**DON'T** open with "I saw you viewed my profile". Most people find that unsettling.

06

SOMETHING CHANGED ON THEIR SIDE

## Changes job title

Medium

Reply: Within 2 weeks

**WHAT IT MEANS**

New roles come with a budget, a mandate and about 90 days to show results. New leaders often switch providers early.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Job-change notifications, "Starting a new position" posts.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Congrats on the new role at [company], [name]. The first months usually mean a fresh look at [area]. If [problem] is on the list, I can share what we've seen work for [similar teams]. Either way, good luck with the start.

**DON'T** pitch in the congratulations. Send the congrats, then follow up a week later with something useful.

07

SOMETHING CHANGED ON THEIR SIDE

## Company starts hiring for the role you replace

High

Reply: This week

**WHAT IT MEANS**

They've admitted the work needs doing and they're about to spend money on it. You can be the faster or cheaper way.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Job posts for [role you replace], e.g. an in-house developer, SDR or marketer.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name], saw [company] is hiring a [role]. While you search: we cover [that work] for teams like yours, starting this week instead of in three months. Worth comparing before you hire, or is the role already decided?

**DON'T** tell them hiring is a mistake. Offer a bridge or an alternative.

08

SOMETHING CHANGED ON THEIR SIDE

## Company raises a round

Medium

Reply: Within 2 weeks

**WHAT IT MEANS**

New money and pressure to grow fast. Plans that waited for budget get unblocked now.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Funding announcements on LinkedIn, Crunchbase, press.

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Congrats on the [round], [name]. Usually the next step is scaling [area] fast. We help [type of company] do that without [common pain]. Is [area] part of the plan for the next quarter?

**DON'T** send the same "congrats on the raise" note as everyone else that week. Add one specific line about their plan.

09

THEY'RE ASKING OUT LOUD

## Posts a "we're looking for" request

Very high

Reply: Same day

### WHAT IT MEANS

They're buying, and they said so in public. Speed matters most here: the first useful reply usually wins.

### WHERE YOU SEE IT

LinkedIn posts like "can anyone recommend a [service] ?" or "we're looking for a [partner] ".

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name] , saw you're looking for a [service] . That's what we do for [type of company] , e.g. [one relevant example] . Two quick questions so I don't waste your time: what's the timeline, and is [key requirement] a must?

**DON'T** reply "DM me" in the comments. Message them directly with something specific.

10

THEY'RE ASKING OUT LOUD

## Complains about a tool in your category

High

Reply: 1–2 days

### WHAT IT MEANS

They're unhappy with what they have, which is the first step to switching.

### WHERE YOU SEE IT

Posts or comments like " [tool] keeps...", "anyone else frustrated with...".

**FIRST MESSAGE**

Hi [name] , saw your post about [tool] and [issue] . You're not the only one; it's the most common reason teams move to us. If you want, I can show you how we handle [issue] in 2 minutes, no call needed.

**DON'T** pile on the tool. Stick to their problem and your fix.

11

THEY'RE ASKING OUT LOUD

## Reddit thread asking for recommendations

High

Reply: 1–2 days

**WHAT IT MEANS**

Someone is researching options, often anonymously and early. These threads keep ranking on Google and get quoted by AI assistants for months.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Subreddits for your buyers, e.g. r/agency, r/smallbusiness, r/SaaS, r/sales.

**FIRST MESSAGE (A PUBLIC REPLY)**

[Answer the question properly first, 3–5 sentences of real advice.] Disclosure: I build [product], which does [this] for [use case], so I'm biased, but [honest one-line comparison].

**DON'T** post a bare link or hide that it's yours. Reddit removes it and the community remembers.

12

THEY'RE ASKING OUT LOUD

## X post tagging a competitor

Medium

Reply: 1–2 days

**WHAT IT MEANS**

They're talking to (or about) a competitor in public: a question, a complaint, a comparison.

**WHERE YOU SEE IT**

Mentions of [competitor]'s handle on X.

**FIRST MESSAGE (A REPLY ON X)**

[Answer their question or acknowledge the issue in one line.] We built [product] for exactly this: [one-line difference]. Happy to show you if useful.

**DON'T** jump into every mention. Reply only when you can add something specific.

ONE PAGE TO KEEP

# Cheat sheet

The strongest signals are people asking out loud. Reply to those first, the same day.

| # | SIGNAL | STRENGTH | REPLY WITHIN | OPENER IN ONE LINE |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| 09 | Posts a "we're looking for" request | Very high | Same day | "Saw you're looking for [service], that's what we do. Timeline?" |
| 01 | Asks a question about the problem you solve | Very high | Same day | Answer the question, then offer the checklist |
| 10 | Complains about a tool in your category | High | 1–2 days | "Most common reason teams switch to us. Want a 2-minute look?" |
| 11 | Reddit thread asking for recommendations | High | 1–2 days | A real answer in the thread, with a disclosure |
| 07 | Company starts hiring for the role you replace | High | This week | "Worth comparing before you hire?" |
| 03 | Comments on a competitor's post | Medium | This week | A second opinion on their point, not an attack |
| 12 | X post tagging a competitor | Medium | 1–2 days | One useful line, then the difference |
| 06 | Changes job title | Medium | Within 2 weeks | Congrats first, something useful a week later |
| 08 | Company raises a round | Medium | Within 2 weeks | Congrats plus one line about their next quarter |
| 02 | Likes three posts on the topic in one week | Medium | This week | Offer a resource on the topic |
| 05 | Views your profile twice | Low | This week | "Our paths crossed", plus what you help with |
| 04 | Follows your profile | Low | Anytime | "Thanks for the follow, what brought you here?" |

## The 20-minute daily routine

1. Check for "looking for" posts and questions in your space. Reply to every one the same day.
2. Check complaints, Reddit threads and competitor mentions. Answer the ones where you can add something.
3. Send the week's job-change, hiring and funding messages in one batch.
4. Log who replied and which opener they replied to. Keep the openers that work, rewrite the rest.

Intentsly.

SKIP THE DAILY SCROLL

# Intentsly watches for these signals for you

It finds the people posting them, scores each one against your ideal customer and drafts the first message in your name. You review and send.

1. **Finds the buyers already asking**
2. **Scores them against your ICP**
3. **Drafts the first message**

See it on your own website **intentsly.com/try-ai →**

No signup needed.

